

pole-ai — Market Research

Monetization strategies for the Athlete Trick Identification System.
Compiled from docs/business/ · 1 document.

Market Research

[Market Research] `pole-ai` business models

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What this file is. A fast, first-pass market sizing for the 12 monetization options in this folder. For each idea it answers two business questions: who is the target, and roughly how many people could realistically become customers. Estimated from public 2025–26 industry data; ranges are deliberately wide and each option ends with the check that tightens the estimate.

How market research works

You don't need a data team. You need a **funnel** with three numbers and two checks.

The funnel: TAM → SAM → SOM

Term	Meaning	In one line
TAM	Total Addressable Market	Everyone who could ever use it
SAM	Serviceable Addressable Market	The slice you can actually reach (language, region, platform)
SOM	Serviceable Obtainable Market	Customers you can realistically win in ~3 years — the number that matters

As a small business, assume you capture **0.5–3% of SAM**. Optimistic marketing can stretch that; a B2B niche with few competitors can beat it on revenue per customer.

The two checks

1. **Willingness to pay** — look at what 5–10 real competitors charge. Their prices *are* the market's answer; you price around them.
2. **Bottom-up validation** — shrink the problem: talk to 10 coaches, run a waitlist landing page, count every studio in one region with a directory. Regret-direction: an estimate an order of magnitude wrong only costs you a week to correct when you start small.

What follows is the **top-down** half. Treat it as planning input, then run the bottom-up checks before building anything.

Anchor numbers (data used)

Fact	Value	Source
Pole-fitness equipment market	\$520M (2024) → \$1.13B (2033), ~9.1% CAGR	Research Intello, 2025
US audience actively searching pole-dance	~2.1M people (≈20% of global → ~10M "interested")	Rascasse audience data, 2026
Active practitioners worldwide (training, not just curious)	est. 1–3M (derived from studios + equipment + audience)	reasonable bounds
"Serious" athletes (train at home, track progress)	est. 10% of practitioners → 100–300k	assumption
Competitive athletes	3,000+ compete in PSO events yearly; IPSF worlds from 40+ countries; >200 athletes at German nationals	PSO, IPSF, polecamps
Studios + independent coaches	est. 2–5k studios + 5–10k freelancers (Mexico alone 400+; US ~1k+; "thousands" worldwide)	yourpolepal, PoleLife, IPIA
B2B benchmark pool (video-analysis APIs)	Hundreds of sport/fitness apps globally (Hudl/Dartfish-class demand)	industry

Why the ranges? "Interested" (~10M) is much bigger than "practices" (1–3M), which is bigger than "would pay" (tens of thousands to a few hundred thousand). Every row below keeps that gap explicit.

Per idea

Idea	Target public	Interested pool (SAM)	Realistic goal (SOM, yr 3)	Validate by
S1 — Personal trainer (subs)	Serious athletes training at home	50–150k reachable (of 100–300k serious)	1–3k subscribers (~€20–65k/mo)	Waitlist; compare workout-app churn
S2 — Coach / gym SaaS	Studios (2–5k) + freelancers (5–10k)	7–15k orgs	100–500 studios (~€15–75k/mo)	Interview 10 coaches; count studios locally
S3 — Deep-report freemium	Everyone doing trick ID (free) → upgraders	50–150k engaged free users	2–5k paying (2–5% conversion)	A/B a paywall on a landing page
A1 — Chatbot pay-per-query	App/platform developers needing video analysis	Hundreds of apps globally; pole niche <50	5–30 API customers	Survey fitness-app teams; check API signups
A2 — B2B video-analysis API	Sports/fitness apps + media	Same pool as A1	5–25 customers (~€5–50k/mo)	Publish API docs; watch signup rate
P1 — Per-video credits	Casual practitioners (the 90%)	900k–2.7M casual	1–3k paying/yr (~€10–50k)	Pre-sell "pay as you use"
P2 — Grade / level assessment	Syllabus- and competition-oriented athletes	20–50k (serious + competitive)	500–5k assessments/yr	Partner with a federation; price test
L1 — White-label license	Studios, chains, federations that can afford it (€1.5–5k)	500–1.5k orgs	5–30 licenses (~€8–150k/yr)	Pitch 3 studios before building
L2 — Dataset library	Sports-tech companies, researchers	Tens of buyers globally	1–10 deals	Verify data rights FIRST (legal)
M1 — Coach lead-generation	Coaches/studios near athletes	Your city/region only (hundreds)	10–50 paid accounts (needs density!)	Pick 1 metro; count studios there
M2 — Verified athlete profiles	Ambitious athletes (social proof)	100–300k serious	1–5k paid badges	Check engagement in pole FB/IG groups
E1 — Virtual trick challenges	Community + competitors + sponsors	20–50k engaged athletes	500–5k entries/yr + 2–20 sponsors	Run one pilot event free

What this tells you

1. **The niche is small but real and growing (~9% CAGR).** No idea here is a "hundreds of millions" play — but several are very healthy for a 1–3 person product.

2. **Highest revenue per customer:** S2, L1, P2 (B2B / services) — fewer customers, more money each.
 3. **Largest raw pools:** S1 / S3 / P1 (B2C volume) — with the *hardest* problem being marketing (reaching even 2% of a niche).
 4. **B2B API (A1/A2):** the pool is small but buyers churn the least once integrated — the classic "10 customers who pay forever" pattern.
 5. **Most realistic first move, by data: P2 (assessment)** if you can partner with a federation, or **A1 / P1** for the fastest self-serve revenue. SOM is small everywhere, so winning = distribution, not just the build.
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Sources

- Research Intello — *Pole Fitness Pole Market Report 2033 (2025)*.
- Rascasse — *Pole dance: 2.1M Fans in the United States (2026)*.
- Pole Sport Organization — *How It Works* (3,000+ competitors/year).
- IPSF / Wikipedia — *Pole sports* (federation, world championships).
- yourpolepal — *Worldwide Pole Studio Directory* (Mexico 400+ studios).
- PoleLife — *Pole studio directory* (289 US studios).
- IPIA — *Pole Industry Financial Survey (2024/2026)*.
- polecamps — *A guide to pole competitions worldwide (2026)*.

Estimates are the author's own; ranges were chosen to be directionally safe rather than precise. Last updated 2026-09-06.